

Full Name:

Semantics: Tutorial on Situations

Francis Bond <bond@ieee.org>

1. Although English does not mark **evidentiality** grammatically, it can be expressed in other ways. Consider the following situation: S "Kim bit Sandy". How could you express the following situations:

- (1) You think S is true, but have no evidence
- (2) You saw S occur
- (3) You saw a bite mark on Sandy, matching Kim's dental work
- (4) Someone told you S
- (5) You are Sandy, and you experienced S

Are any of these expressed grammatically in a language that you speak?

2. Make up examples of each of the following semantic roles and translate the example into a language of your choice.

- agent
- patient
- theme
- experiencer
- beneficiary
- location
- source
- goal
- stimulus
- instrument

3. Make up examples of the following modalities and translate the example into a language of your choice.

- Epistemic (knowledge)
 - auxilliary
 - main verb
 - adverb
- Deontic (permission/obligation)
 - auxilliary
 - main verb
 - adverb